

3G: More Bandwidth, More Speed, More Applications

3G has tremendous potential in terms of content and services. It also provides enhanced voice quality. But penetration of 3G usage is influenced by a variety of factors

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In simple words, 3G means more interesting applications, more multimedia and more fun. 3G network allows a very high data rate, which, in turn, will push the growth of content and services that require high-speed data transfer. To avail all this, of course, you need a 3G phone and a 3G network. But not all the services offered by 3G are meant for everyone.

3G is the oxygen for mobile content and services. There is a tremendous potential in terms of value-added services and revenue which is yet to be explored. "3G is a big pipeline. You have to find an application in this pipeline for enhanced user experience," says Rahul Sharma, CEO of Micromax Informatics. 3G will enable services like 'live' TV for cricket and Bollywood updates for the masses and applications like video conferencing for the professionals.

There are a variety of factors that will influence the usage of 3G network. Some already have solutions, while others still need some thought.

Cost of the handset

"When we talk about 3G, multimedia and entertainment will come out to be the strongest application area," informs Dhiraj Soni, head, product group marketing, Sony Ericsson.

It's not just the 3G-compatible chip that contributes to the high price of the handset. Most 3G phones need to have a good-quality display, good camera and good-quality audio. Let's say, you want to watch a live TV programme commemorating Sachin's 20 glorious years in international cricket. You will need a good display and audio other than high-speed data transfer in order to actually enjoy the live TV broadcast.

The purpose of video conferencing is to let you see the person who is talking from the other end. You need a camera that can capture clear images, a highly responsive software to digitise the picture and then, of course, 3G network to transmit the pictures in real time. Many 3G phones have two cameras, one at the back for regular image capturing



Sony Ericsson Xperia X2 3G phone